CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 10

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Ship of the Desert

Nothing is more closely linked to the picture of Rajasthan than the camel. It is called the 'ship of the desert', because it carries people and goods over a sea of sand. There are two main kinds of camel. The one-humped dromedary is found in India, Africa and West Asia, while the two-humped Bactrian lives in the cold deserts of Central Asia.

The camel's body is wonderfully made for desert life. Its broad, padded feet keep it from sinking into the sand. Its long eyelashes and two rows of lashes on each eye protect it from the blowing dust, and it can close its nostrils during sandstorms. Contrary to popular belief, the hump does not store water; it stores fat, which the animal can use as food when none is available. A thirsty camel can drink as much as a hundred litres of water in a few minutes and then go for days without another drink.

For the people of Rajasthan the camel is a friend as well as a worker. It ploughs fields, pulls carts, carries water and loads of grain and takes tourists across the dunes. Its milk is nutritious and its wool is made into blankets. Each year in November, the famous Pushkar Fair brings thousands of camels and traders together, and the sandy fields come alive with colours, music and bargaining.

Sadly, the number of camels in the state is falling, because tractors and trucks have taken over much of their work and grazing land has shrunk. The government has declared the camel the state animal of Rajasthan and has made it illegal to take camels out of the state for slaughter. If this noble animal is to survive, then local people and visitors alike must value its place in the desert's story.

(i) The camel is called the 'ship of the desert' because it: 1

(a) carries people and goods across sand **(b)** floats on water
(c) is very large **(d)** lives in ships

(ii) The hump of a camel stores: 1

(a) milk **(b)** water **(c)** fat **(d)** air

(iii) Long eyelashes protect the camel from: 1

(a) heat **(b)** blowing dust **(c)** rain **(d)** insects

(iv) The Pushkar Fair is held in: 1

(a) November **(b)** March **(c)** June **(d)** August

(v) The word 'noble' in the last paragraph means: 1

(a) cruel **(b)** weak
(c) dignified and admirable **(d)** common

(vi) State whether True or False: The hump of a camel stores water. Correct if false. 1

(vii) What keeps the camel from sinking into the sand? 1

(viii) Mention two ways in which people of Rajasthan use the camel. 1

(ix) Why is the number of camels falling? 1

(x) What step has the government taken to protect the camel? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

My School Bag

My bag is a very curious thing,
It hides more secrets than a king.
There's a broken pencil, a half-eaten bun,
A colouring book that is never done.

There's a crumpled note from a friend named Tina,
A sticker of a rainbow-coloured hyena,
A bottle that leaks on my history book,
And a ruler that has a mysterious crook.

It's heavy at morning and heavier at night,
As it carries my lessons and my little delight;
My shoulders ache and my back complains,
But I wouldn't swap it for a hundred trains.

For inside its pockets, tucked in tight,
Are my dreams, my doodles and my hopes of flight;
And when I grow old and my hair turns grey,
I shall open this bag on a rainy day.

(i) The poet's school bag is compared to: 1

(a) a king who hides secrets **(b)** a train
(c) a house **(d)** a pillow

(ii) The bottle in the bag: 1

(a) leaks on the history book **(b)** is full of juice
(c) is empty **(d)** is broken

(iii) The bag is heavy because it carries: 1

(a) only books **(b)** food
(c) lessons and little delights **(d)** bricks

(iv) The poet says 'I wouldn't swap it for a hundred trains' to show that: 1

(a) trains are slow **(b)** the bag is very precious
(c) she likes travelling **(d)** she has many bags

(v) The tone of the poem is: 1

(a) light-hearted and affectionate **(b)** sad
(c) serious **(d)** angry

(vi) Name two things found in the bag. 1

(vii) What does the poet's back do by the end of the day? 1

(viii) What does the poet keep in the pockets of the bag? 1

(ix) Pick out a pair of rhyming words from the first stanza. 1

(x) When will the poet open the bag again? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND